

Word family: **message / messages / messaged / messaging / messenger**

Base word: message

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **message** (n.) — 訊息；信息；留言；主旨；寓意

* **message** (v.) — 傳訊息給；發短訊給

* **messaging** (n.) — 傳訊；訊息溝通；宣傳訊息策略

* **messenger** (n.) — 信使；傳訊者；傳遞訊息的程式 / 系統

* **instant messaging** — 即時通訊

* **text message** — 短訊

* **voice message** — 語音留言

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **send a message**

* **leave a message**

* **get / receive a message**

* **text message**

* **voice message**

* **message someone**

* **get the message**

* **send a clear message**

* **the message of a story**

* **underlying message**

* **mixed messages**

* **message board**

* **instant messaging**

* **brand messaging**

Meaning in this passage

> I had to sort through hundreds of old photos, choose the right ones, and write **messages** that sounded sincere instead of overly dramatic.

Here, **messages** means:

short personal written notes expressing thoughts, feelings, or memories — 留言；心意文字；短句

The speaker wrote short personal pieces of text inside the handmade album.

****中文翻譯：****

我需要從幾百張舊照片裡慢慢挑選合適的，再寫上一些聽起來真誠、而不會太煽情的****留言 / 心意文字****。

So here:

**message = 寫給某人的簡短文字，用來表達心意、感受或想說的話**

1. **message (訊息；信息) — 訊息；消息**

This is the broad core sense.

Practice 1

> I got a ****message**** from my friend.

我收到朋友的一則****訊息****。

Practice 2

> Please send me a ****message**** when you arrive.

你到達後請傳一則****訊息****給我。

Practice 3

> The ****message**** said the meeting had been cancelled.

那則****訊息****說會議取消了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****message = 傳給另一個人或群體的一段資訊、通知或內容****

2. **personal message — 私人留言；心意文字**

This is closest to your passage.

Practice 1 — passage-related

> I wrote a short ****message**** beside each photo.

我在每張照片旁邊寫了一段簡短的**留言**。

Practice 2

> She added a **personal message** to the card.

她在卡片上加了一段**有心意的私人留言**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal message = 直接寫給某個人的簡短文字，帶有私人或感情色彩

3. **write a message — 寫訊息 / 留言**

Practice 1

> She **wrote a message** inside the album.

她在相簿裏**寫了一段留言**。

Practice 2

> I **wrote him a message** to say thank you.

我**寫訊息給他**表示感謝。

MCQ-ready definition:

write a message = 寫下一段要傳達給某人的短文字

4. **send a message — 傳送訊息**

Practice 1

> I'll **send you a message** later.

我稍後會**傳訊息給你**。

Practice 2

> She **sent a message** to the group.

她**傳了一則訊息**到群組。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****send a message = 把文字、語音或其他資訊傳給某人****

5. ****leave a message — 留言****

A very common expression.

Practice 1

> She wasn't available, so I ****left a message****.

她當時不方便，所以我****留了言****。

Practice 2

> Please ****leave a message**** after the tone.

請在提示聲後****留言****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave a message = 在對方暫時不能回應時留下要傳達的內容****

6. ****get / receive a message — 收到訊息****

Practice 1

> Did you ****get my message****?

你有****收到我的訊息****嗎？

Practice 2

> I ****received a message**** from the school.

我收到學校的一則****通知 / 訊息****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****get/receive a message = 接收到別人傳來的資訊****

7. ****text message — 短訊；文字訊息****

Practice 1

> She sent me a **text message**.

她傳了一則**短訊**給我。

Practice 2

> I received three **text messages** this morning.

我今早收到三則**文字訊息**。

MCQ-ready definition:

text message = 透過手機或通訊系統傳送的短文字訊息

8. **voice message** — 語音留言

Practice 1

> He left me a **voice message**.

他給我留了一則**語音留言**。

Practice 2

> I listened to her **voice message** twice.

我聽了她的**語音訊息**兩次。

MCQ-ready definition:

voice message = 錄製並傳送給別人的語音內容

9. **message someone** — 傳訊息給某人

Verb sense.

Practice 1

> **Message me** when you arrive.

你到達後**傳訊息給我**。

Practice 2

> I **messed her** last night.

我昨晚**傳了訊息給她**。

MCQ-ready definition:

message someone = 用手機、電腦或通訊程式傳訊息給某人

10. **messaging — 即時通訊；傳訊**

Practice 1

> We usually communicate through **messaging** apps.

我們通常用**即時通訊**應用程式溝通。

Practice 2

> **Messaging** has become a common way to stay in touch.

傳訊已成為保持聯絡的常見方式。

MCQ-ready definition:

messaging = 透過電子裝置傳送短訊息的活動或系統

11. **instant messaging — 即時通訊**

Practice 1

> The team uses **instant messaging** during work.

團隊工作時使用**即時通訊**。

Practice 2

> **Instant messaging** allows quick communication.

即時通訊可以快速交流。

MCQ-ready definition:

****instant messaging = 透過網絡即時傳送和接收文字訊息的系統****

12. ****message (主旨 ; 要傳達的重點) — 主旨 ; 核心信息****

A major abstract sense.

Practice 1

> What is the main ****message**** of the speech?

這篇演講的主要****訊息 / 主旨****是甚麼？

Practice 2

> The advertisement sends a positive ****message****.

這則廣告傳達了一個正面的****信息****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****message = 某段說話、文章、藝術作品或行動想傳達的核心意思****

13. ****the message of a story / film — 故事 / 電影的寓意 ; 主旨****

Practice 1

> The ****message of the story**** is about kindness.

故事的****寓意****是善良。

Practice 2

> The film has a strong environmental ****message****.

這部電影帶有很強的環保****主旨****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****message of a story/film = 作品希望觀眾理解的主要思想、價值或寓意****

14. ****underlying message — 深層信息 ; 隱含意思****

Practice 1

> The **underlying message** is that family matters more than money.

背後的**深層信息**是家庭比金錢更重要。

Practice 2

> The advertisement has an **underlying message** about status.

這則廣告隱含一個關於身份地位的**信息**。

MCQ-ready definition:

underlying message = 沒有直接明說，但可從內容中理解到的深層意思

15. **send a message (用行動表態)** — 傳遞訊號；表明立場

A figurative extension.

Practice 1

> The decision **sends a clear message** that the rules matter.

這個決定**清楚傳達**了一個訊號：規則很重要。

Practice 2

> Her refusal **sent a message** to the rest of the team.

她的拒絕向團隊其他人**傳達了明確立場**。

MCQ-ready definition:

send a message = 透過行動、決定或言論向別人表明某種態度、立場或意圖

16. **send a clear / strong message** — 傳達清楚 / 強烈訊號

Practice 1

> The new rule **sends a strong message** about safety.

新規則就安全問題**傳達了強烈訊號**。

Practice 2

> His reaction **sent a clear message** that he disagreed.

他的反應**清楚表明**他不同意。

MCQ-ready definition:

send a clear/strong message = 讓某種立場或態度變得非常明確

17. **get the message — 明白暗示 / 意思**

A very common idiom.

Practice 1

> He stopped calling after he finally **got the message**.

他終於**明白對方的意思**後，就不再打電話了。

Practice 2

> I think she **got the message**.

我想她已經**明白暗示**了。

MCQ-ready definition:

get the message = 明白別人沒有直接說出口的暗示、意圖或要求

18. **message received — 明白了；收到指示**

Literal and figurative.

Practice 1

> “Don't be late again.” “**Message received**.”

「不要再遲到了。」 「**明白。**」

Practice 2

> His expression made it clear: **message received**.

他的表情很清楚表示：****我懂了。****

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****message received = 表示自己已經理解對方的要求、警告或暗示****

19. ****mixed messages — 矛盾訊息；前後不一致的暗示****

A major expression.

Practice 1

> He is sending me ****mixed messages****.

他給我的****訊號很矛盾****。

Practice 2

> The policy sends ****mixed messages**** about what is expected.

這項政策對應有的要求傳達出****前後不一致的訊息****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mixed messages = 서로 conflicting signals or statements that make someone's real meaning unclear****

中文：

****互相矛盾、令人難以判斷真正意思的訊息或暗示****

20. ****message board — 留言板；討論區****

Practice 1

> Users posted questions on the ****message board****.

用戶在****留言板 / 討論區****發問。

Practice 2

> The school's ****message board**** displays announcements.

學校的****公告板****展示通知。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****message board = 供人張貼訊息、公告或討論內容的實體或網上空間****

21. ****messenger (傳訊者 ; 信使) — 信使 ; 傳令人****

Practice 1

> A ****messenger**** delivered the letter.

一名****信使****送來了信件。

Practice 2

> The king sent a ****messenger**** with the news.

國王派出一名****傳令者****送出消息。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****messenger = 負責把訊息、文件或物件帶給另一方的人****

22. ****messenger (通訊程式 / 服務) — 即時通訊工具****

Practice 1

> They spoke through an online ****messenger****.

他們透過網上****通訊程式****聊天。

Practice 2

> The ****messenger**** supports voice calls and file sharing.

這個****通訊工具****支援語音通話和檔案分享。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****messenger = 用來傳送即時訊息的數碼通訊程式或服務****

23. ****messaging (宣傳 / 品牌訊息策略) — 對外訊息 ; 傳訊策略****

A business/communications sense.

Practice 1

> The company's **messaging** focuses on simplicity.

公司的**對外傳訊**集中強調簡單。

Practice 2

> The campaign needs clearer **messaging**.

這個宣傳活動需要更清晰的**訊息策略**。

MCQ-ready definition:

messaging = 組織或品牌有計劃地向公眾傳達的核心說法、主題和語言

24. **brand messaging** — 品牌傳訊；品牌核心訊息

Practice 1

> Their **brand messaging** emphasizes reliability.

他們的**品牌傳訊**強調可靠。

Practice 2

> The new design does not match the company's **brand messaging**.

新設計與公司的**品牌核心訊息**不一致。

MCQ-ready definition:

brand messaging = 品牌用來表達自身定位、價值和特色的一套核心訊息

Important distinction 1: **message** vs **information**

information

facts or knowledge.

message

information deliberately sent or communicated.

> useful information

有用資料

> a message from my mother

媽媽傳來的訊息

So not all information is a message.

Important distinction 2: **message vs note**

Very relevant to your passage.

message

focuses on what you want to communicate.

note

often focuses on a short written piece itself.

> write a message in the album

在相簿寫心意文字

> leave a note on the table

在桌上留紙條

They can overlap strongly.

Important distinction 3: **message vs caption**

Also directly relevant to this passage.

caption

explains a photo/image.

message

expresses something to the reader/recipient.

For example:

> Caption: "Family trip, 2023."

> Message: "Thank you for always making these trips special."

So:

caption = 解釋照片

message = 表達心意

Important distinction 4: **message vs text**

message

broad:

- * text

- * voice

- * app notification

- * personal note

text / text message

specifically written electronic message, especially by phone.

So every text is a message, but not every message is a text.

Important distinction 5: **message vs email**

email

specific communication medium.

message

broader content/unit of communication.

An email is a type of message.

Important distinction 6: **message vs announcement**

message

can be private or public.

announcement

usually public or official information.

> a message to my friend

給朋友的訊息

> a school announcement

學校公告

Important distinction 7: **message = communication vs message = meaning**

Communication

> I received a message.

我收到訊息。

Meaning

> The message of the film is clear.

電影的主旨很清楚。

These are two major semantic branches.

Important distinction 8: **send a message literal vs figurative**

Literal

> Send me a message.

傳訊息給我。

Figurative

> His decision sent a message.

他的決定傳達了一種立場。

The second does not require an actual text or phone message.

Important distinction 9: ****get the message literal vs idiomatic****

Literal

> Did you get my message?

你收到我的訊息嗎？

Idiomatic

> I think he finally got the message.

我想他終於****明白暗示****了。

Same words, different sense.

Important distinction 10: ****mixed messages vs different messages****

****different messages****

simply multiple different pieces of communication.

****mixed messages****

signals that conflict with one another.

> She says yes but acts as if she means no.

That is ****mixed messages****.

Important distinction 11: **messenger vs message**

message

the content.

messenger

the person/system carrying it.

A classic idea:

> Don't blame the messenger.

不要因為不喜歡消息而怪傳話的人。

25. **shoot the messenger — 遷怒報信者**

A fixed idiom.

Practice 1

> Don't **shoot the messenger**—I'm just telling you what happened.

不要**遷怒報信的人**——我只是告訴你發生了甚麼。

Practice 2

> Managers should not **shoot the messenger** when employees report problems.

當員工報告問題時，管理層不應**怪罪傳達壞消息的人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

shoot the messenger = blame the person who brings bad news instead of dealing with the actual problem

中文：

把壞消息帶來的不快怪到傳話者身上

Important distinction 12: ****message as verb vs text as verb****

****message someone****

broad electronic communication.

****text someone****

specifically send a text-based message, usually by phone.

> Message me later.

之後傳訊息給我。

> Text me the address.

用短訊把地址傳給我。

Family-extension note

****Message**** has four major modern branches:

1. ****individual communication****

- * send a message
- * leave a message
- * voice message

2. ****personal written expression****

- * personal message
- * message in a card/album

3. ****underlying meaning / theme****

- * message of a story
- * underlying message

4. ****signal conveyed by actions****

- * send a clear message
- * get the message
- * mixed messages

The family then expands into:

5. **digital communication**

- * message someone
- * messaging
- * instant messaging

6. **professional communications**

- * brand messaging

7. **carrier**

- * messenger
- * shoot the messenger

For your passage, the exact sense is:

a short personal written note expressing sincere feeling

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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message	訊息；消息	communication
personal message	私人 / 心意留言	personal expression
write a message	寫留言 / 訊息	create message
send a message	傳訊息	transmit
leave a message	留言	message for later
receive a message	收到訊息	receive communication
text message	短訊	written mobile message
voice message	語音留言	recorded speech
message someone	傳訊息給某人	verb
messaging	傳訊；即時通訊	communication activity
instant messaging	即時通訊	real-time messages
message (theme)	主旨；寓意	central meaning
underlying message	隱含信息	deeper meaning
send a message (figurative)	傳遞訊號 / 表態	communicate indirectly
get the message	明白暗示	understand implication
message received	明白了	understood
mixed messages	矛盾訊號	conflicting signals
message board	留言板 / 討論區	posted messages
messenger	信使；傳訊者	carrier

messenger (digital)	通訊程式	communication tool	
brand messaging	品牌傳訊	strategic communication	
shoot the messenger	遷怒報信者	blame bearer of bad news	

For your original sentence

> I had to sort through hundreds of old photos, choose the right ones, and write **messages** that sounded sincere instead of overly dramatic.

Here:

messages = 寫在相簿裏、用來表達感情或回憶的簡短心意文字

They are different from the earlier **captions**:

* **caption** → identifies/explains a photo

* **message** → expresses a thought, feeling, thanks, or memory

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我需要從幾百張舊照片裏慢慢挑選合適的，再寫上一些聽起來真誠而不會太煽情的**留言 / 心意文字**。

For this passage, **「留言」** is the cleanest general translation, while **「心意文字」** captures the emotional nuance especially well.